

Education and learning

Speaking Part 1

Imagine that you are preparing a project with your friend. You have found some interesting material for the presentation and you want to read this text to your friend. You have 1.5 minutes to read the text silently, then be ready to read it out aloud. You will not have more than 1.5 minutes to read it.

Education plays a vital role in the lives of teenagers in Russia. The education system focuses on providing a comprehensive and well-rounded education to prepare them for the future. Teenagers attend secondary schools, where they study a wide range of subjects, including mathematics, sciences, languages, social sciences, and humanities. With a strong emphasis on academic achievement, students are encouraged to excel in their studies.

In addition to academics, extracurricular activities are an important part of the educational experience for teenagers in Russia. They have access to various clubs, sports teams, and creative outlets, which help them develop their talents and interests. Furthermore, there is an increasing emphasis on digital literacy and technology integration in education. Teenagers are exposed to modern tools and resources to enhance their learning experience. The Russian government also focuses on providing equal opportunities for education. Scholarships and financial aid programs are available to help students from disadvantaged backgrounds access quality education.

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement

Study with us anywhere at any time!



You are considering taking an online course and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. program used;
2. number of classes per week;
3. assessment;
4. choice of a teacher.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Science and technology. Answers for Writing Task 38. Task 2:

Many inventions were introduced from 1900 to 1999. I am currently doing a project on Zetlanders' opinion on the most influential invention of the 20th century and I have found some results of a survey in the form of a pie chart.

As can be seen in the statistics, approximately the same number of the respondents say that the television and the computer has influenced the world the most (26% and 25% respectively). Only 4% choose nuclear power.

Predictably, more than three times as many of the respondents choose the airplane to be the most influential invention of that period of time (34%) as those who say that it is the radio (11%). It is probably because the airplane gives people an opportunity to travel all around the globe while the radio is just a means of entertainment.

New inventions usually bring many opportunities to people but there could be a problem that is not easy to resolve. If an invention is new, it may not have gone through proper approbation and might do harm to people. For instance, a few years ago there was a telephone that exploded accidentally. To tackle the problem, organisations should sell a limited number of devices to check that they are safe for all people.

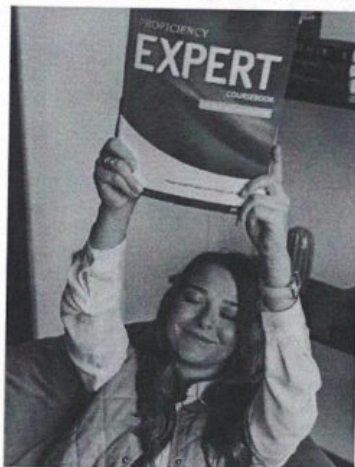
To conclude, I believe that inventions are of utmost importance to society. Technological advancements are essential for the better world that every one of us wants to live in.

We use the definite article (the) with technological intentions. Keep in mind that sometimes articles should be used with the notions presented in the table\pie chart although they might not be written in the task.

Speaking Part 2. Task 2

Study the advertisement

Prepare for Cambridge exams with us!



You are considering taking a course and now you'd like to get more information. In 1.5 minutes you are to ask four direct questions to find out about the following:

1. days of studying;
2. tuition fees;
3. number of students in one group;
4. if they give a certificate.

You have 20 seconds to ask each question.

Speaking Part 3. Task 1.

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions. Give full answers to the questions (2–3 sentences). Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's Teenagers Round the World Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss education. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: What is your favourite subject at school? Why?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Do you usually remember things that you have studied?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What sort of techniques do you use to help you remember what you have studied?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How important do you think it is to go to university?

Student: _____

Interviewer: What is the best way to make teenagers motivated to learn?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Speaking part 3. Task 2

You are going to give an interview. You have to answer five questions. Give full answers to the questions (2-3 sentences).

Remember that you have 40 seconds to answer each question.

Tapescript for Task 3

Interviewer: Hello everybody! It's *Teenagers Round the World* Channel. Our guest today is a teenager from Russia and we are going to discuss studying in Russia. We'd like to know our guest's point of view on this issue. Please answer five questions. So, let's get started.

Interviewer: Do you enjoy studying? What is your favourite subject at school and why?

Student: _____

Interviewer: When was the last time you took an exam? How was it?

Student: _____

Interviewer: How do you usually revise before the exam? How long does it usually take?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Are any of your friends interested in studying English? Why or why not?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Why is online education getting to be more and more popular? Do you think people will only study online one day?

Student: _____

Interviewer: Thank you very much for your interview.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 1:

1. What kind of program do you use for teaching your online course?
2. How many classes will I have per week? How many classes do you give per week?
3. How do you assess student's progress?
4. Can I choose a teacher?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 2. Task 2:

1. What days do you have lessons in your online course?
2. What are the tuition fees?
3. How many students are there in one group?
4. Do you provide students with a certificate at the end of the course?

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 1:

1. My favourite subject is maths. I like counting and dealing with formulas.
2. I remember all the things I have studied quite well. Whenever I need to learn something, I do it quickly. It's not hard to remember things for me.
3. I usually use associations to remember things. For example, when I need to remember some facts, I think of the facts I already know and try to figure out the connection.
4. I believe it's of utmost importance for people to go to university. It teaches certain skills people don't usually learn at school. People also meet deadlines better if they have studied at university.
5. The best way is to give them topics that they are interested in or asking them to draw a parallel between the subject and something they like. This way it's easier for teenagers to study and they remember things better.

Suggested answers for Speaking Part 3. Task 2:

1. I enjoy studying very much. I do it all the time. My favourite subject at school is English. I have to learn lots of words all the time and this is what I enjoy.
2. The last time I took an exam was last week. I took a Literature exam. It was not very hard. I think I'll get a good grade but I don't know the results yet.
3. I usually use my notebooks to revise. I take lots of notes when I study and it's very convenient to revise using these notes. It usually takes a few days.
4. All of my friends are interested in studying English. It's a global language and speaking it can give all of us an opportunity to get a decent job. My friends understand this and this is why they learn it.
5. Surely, online education is getting more and more popular. It's very convenient. You can study wherever you want. I don't think people will only study online though. The advantages of studying in person still outweigh some of the benefits of studying online.

Speaking Part 4. Advantages and disadvantages

Match the following advantages and disadvantages to the topics.

The two types of studying...	Advantages	Disadvantages
online		
in class		
on your own		
in a group		

- a. you can do it wherever you want
- b. it could be boring
- c. the atmosphere is more motivating
- d. you can take as much time as you want to
- e. more difficult to communicate with your classmates during the lesson
- f. ask about something and find out the answer straight away
- g. you have an opportunity to go abroad and not to miss classes.
- h. you have to skip classes if you fall ill
- i. you can hear other people's ideas
- j. it's easier for a teacher to explain things
- k. it's difficult for shy people to express their ideas in front of others
- l. no one can make you rush
- m. there's no one to ask
- n. you may not be allocated any time to say what you want during the lesson

Read the following suggested answers.

Suggested answer:

In general, both ways of studying foreign languages have their pros and cons. One of the advantages of studying via a computer is that you can do it wherever you want. You have an opportunity to go abroad and not to miss classes. At the same time, when you are in a class, the atmosphere is more motivating and it's easier for a teacher to explain things when their students are in front of them.

However, there are also some disadvantages of studying foreign languages these ways. It's more difficult to communicate with your classmates during the lesson if you study online. As for studying offline, you have to skip classes if you fall ill.

Suggested answer:

There are some advantages of studying in both of these ways. If you learn something alone, you can take as much time as you want to and no one can make you rush. Learning in a group could also be beneficial for a student. You can hear other people's ideas or ask about something and find out the answer straight away, since some of the students might already have dealt with this problem.

People can also experience some disadvantages studying in both of these ways. If a person studies on their own, there's no one to ask and it could be boring. At the same time, it's difficult for shy people to express their ideas in front of others. Sometimes, you may not be allocated any time to say what you want during the lesson because it's not possible to ask every student every time. I believe these are major disadvantages.

Answers for Speaking Part 4. Advantages and disadvantages:

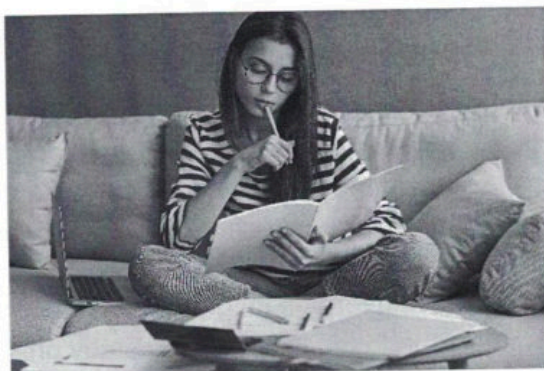
The two types of studying...	Advantages	Disadvantages
online	a, (f), g	e, (n)
in class	c, (f), j (i)	h
on your own	d, l	b, m
in a group	c, f, i	k, n

Speaking Part 4. Task 2

Imagine that you and your friend are doing a school project "Taking notes for learning". You have found some photos to illustrate it but for technical reasons you cannot send them now. Leave a voice message to your friend explaining your choice of the photos and sharing some ideas about the project. In 2.5 minutes be ready to:

- explain the choice of the illustrations for the project by briefly describing them and noting the differences;
- mention the advantages (1-2) of the two ways of taking notes;
- mention the disadvantages (1-2) of the two ways of taking notes;
- express your opinion on the subject of the project – which way of taking notes presented in the pictures you preferred when you were a child and why.

You will speak for not more than 3 minutes (12-15 sentences). You have to talk continuously.



Writing an email. Asking questions

Read the following sentences from emails. Make up questions that you could ask.

Next week we'll have a fancy-dress ball at school.

Ask 3 questions about the fancy-dress ball.

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Last month I took part in a school sports contest...

Ask 3 questions about the sports contest.

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Ask 3 questions about his participation in the contest.

- 1) _____
- 2) _____
- 3) _____

Real-life Task 38

Quick questionnaire

Follow the QR-code link or the link below. Answer the question about the best way to prepare for an exam and see the results of other students.

Take a picture of the results and write your data description. Compare two figures and give a comment. Since it's a real-life opinion poll, the results change all the time, so you can do the task again in a while. Keep in mind that the respondents are Russian teenagers.

Address the following:

- outline a problem that can arise with preparing for an exam and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the importance of taking exams.

<https://forms.gle/znviD82KuoSHAXwJ9>



Suggested answer for Speaking Part 4. Task 2:

Hi Sveta, it's Masha. I've found two suitable pictures for our project "Taking notes for learning". I'd like to tell you about the pictures and what I think about taking notes.

I guess we should use the illustrations because in both of them there are some girls who are taking notes. In the first picture, I can see a girl sitting on the sofa and studying, she is holding a notebook and a pen. I think she might be revising for her exam. In the second picture there's a girl with a tablet and a stylus /'stai.ləs/. She is probably reading something and might also be taking some notes. The difference between the pictures is in the things the girls are using for taking notes: a notebook and an electronic device.

There are some advantages of using both of the ways of taking notes. Scientists say that you remember things better when you write them down. If you use electronic devices, it's much faster to take notes and you can copy some sections and paste them in your notes.

However, both of the ways also feature some disadvantages. Sometimes a pen won't write, especially when you hang the notebook. A battery in an electronic device may go dead. In this case you won't be able to read or take any notes.

When I was a child, I preferred to use notebooks for taking notes. I liked writing in hand and I also liked drawing pictures while I was listening to the teacher.

That's all for now. Call me back in the evening to discuss the project. Bye.

Suggested answers for Writing an email. Task 1

Fancy-dress ball:

How many students are going to come?

Are any kinds of costumes allowed to wear at the ball or are there any restrictions?

Will it start in the evening or in the afternoon?

Will there only be students or will teacher be also allowed to join in?

Sports contest:

Was it long?

Who won?

What was the prize for the winner?

What sports were there in the contest?

How many competitors were there?

His participation in the contest:

Did you win?

What sport did you do in the contest?

How did you feel during the contest?

Were you satisfied with your place?

Writing an email. Task 2

You have received an email message from your English-speaking pen-friend Mary.

Read an answer to the email bellow. Try to find as many different types of grammar mistakes as possible.

From: Mary@mail.uk

To: Russian_friend@ege.ru

Subject: Learning strategies

... I'm having a huge test next week on my German lesson. Unfortunately, I'm really bad at learning new words. How do you learn new words and phrases? How much time do you usually spend to memorise new words? Do you forget them all after taking a test? ... My father has bought a new computer for me...

Write an email to Mary.

In your message:

- answer her questions;
- ask **3 questions** about her new computer.

Write **100–140 words**.

Remember the rules of email writing.

Student's answer:

Dear Mary,

Thanks a lot for your email. It's always nice hearing from you.

You wondered how I learn new word and phrase. Well, I learn a new vocabulary on Wordstool.com. I usually make some sets for myself or my teacher send me some tasks. I do them daily and spent about 10 to 30 minutes to that. A new set of words usually take 15 minutes to learn. Actually, I don't forget some words because it's a revision module on the website. I just arrange some tasks for myself and they pop up in due time.

By the way, tell me about your new computer. Is it PC or laptop? How much memory is it? Is it fast?

Write back soon.

All the best,

Mila

(128 words)

Suggested answer for Writing an email. Task 2

There are 9 types of grammar mistakes in the answer.

Dear Mary,

Thanks a lot for your email. It's always nice to hear from you.

You wondered how I learn new words and phrases. Well, I learn new vocabulary on Wordstool.com. I usually make some sets for myself or my teacher sends me some tasks. I do them daily and spend about 10 to 30 minutes on that. A new set of words usually takes 15 minutes to learn. Actually, I don't forget any words because there's a revision module on the website. I just arrange some tasks for myself and they pop up in due time.

By the way, tell me about your new computer. Is it a PC or a laptop? How much memory is there? Is it fast?

Write back soon.

All the best,

Mila

128 words

Writing Task 38. Task 1

Study the task. Read a student's essay and choose one of the alternatives for each of the sentences. Underline it. There is always something wrong with the other sentence. Explain what is wrong.

Imagine that you are doing a project on **what skills Zetland teenagers want to learn**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the table below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.

Write 200–250 words.

The survey question: What skills do you want to learn?	
Skills:	Number of respondents (%)
Driving a car	38
Snowboarding	24
Speaking a foreign language	16
Dancing	12
Cooking	10

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2–3 facts;
- make 1–2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that can arise with developing new skills and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the most important skill to learn for you.

1) Teenagers like learning new skills. Adolescence is the time when people learn to do very many things. 2) I am currently doing a project on what skills Zetland teenagers want to learn. I've done a project on what skills Zetland teenagers want to learn. 3) I have found some results of a survey in the form of a table, which I am going to analyse. I have found a table, which is presented below.

4) According to the table, it is driving a car (38%). According to the statistics, the most popular skill to learn among Zetland teenagers is driving a car (38%). 5) Almost one-fifth of the respondents want to learn how to speak a foreign language (16%). 16% of the respondents want to learn how to speak a foreign language. 6) One-tenth of the young Zetlanders are interested in learning how to cook. Moreover, 10% of young Zetlanders are interested in learning how to cook.

7) Interestingly, more teenagers in Zetland prefer snowboarding to dancing, 24% and 12% respectively. Interestingly, twice as many of the teenagers are eager to learn how to snowboard (24%) as those who want to learn to dance (12%). 8) It seems logical as snowboarding is very popular among modern teenagers. It seems logical as many of my friends like snowboarding. 9) Teenagers like to show off and it is one of the ways. Teenagers are showing off and it seems one of the ways. 10) Dancing is a much simpler activity to learn. Dancing is not interesting for teenagers.

11) Unfortunately, it is difficult for teenagers to develop new skills, thus, there are many problems. Unfortunately, when people develop new skills, they can face certain problems. 12) One of them is giving up what they learn once they experience difficulties. One of them is that he may give up what he learns once he experiences difficulties. 13) To tackle the problem, such people should find teachers that motivate and encourage their students no matter how fast their progress is. Tackling the problem, such people should find teachers that motivate and encourage their students no matter how fast their progress is. 14) Teacher should always support their students. This could help learn from mistakes and help people continue mastering their skills.

15) To sum up, I believe the most important skill to learn for me is critical thinking. In conclusion, I believe the most important skill to learn for me is critical thinking. 16) Critical thinking is the skill everyone should develop. It helps measure possible outcomes and sift through a great deal of information I obtain daily.

Answer for Writing Task 38. Task 1

The right alternatives are:

1) Adolescence is the time when people learn to do very many things. (The first sentence is too simple and overgeneralized). 2) I am currently doing a project on what skills Zetland teenagers want to learn. (You are still doing your project according to the task). 3) I have found some results of a survey in the form of a table, which I am going to analyse. (It's a content mistake as it's an essay and there's no table below, there are only some statistics).

4) According to the statistics, the most popular skill to learn among Zetland teenagers is driving a car (38%). (You have to state what you refer to). 5) 16% of the respondents want to learn how to speak a foreign language. (16% is not almost one-fifth. It's not accurate.) 6) One-tenth of young Zetlanders are interested in learning how to cook. (You cannot use 'moreover' to add a point).

7) Interestingly, twice as many of the teenagers are eager to learn how to snowboard (24%) as those who want to learn to dance (12%). (The data is not something teenagers prefer doing, maybe they've never tried it. It's something they want to learn how to do). 8) It seems logical as snowboarding is very popular among modern teenagers. (Your sentence should be general, do not introduce your own experience in the first four paragraphs). 9) Teenagers like to show off and it is one of the ways. (Wrong tense – you cannot use Present Continuous to introduce facts). 10) Dancing is a much simpler activity to learn. (The second sentence contradicts the statistics. 12% of the teenagers want to learn how to dance).

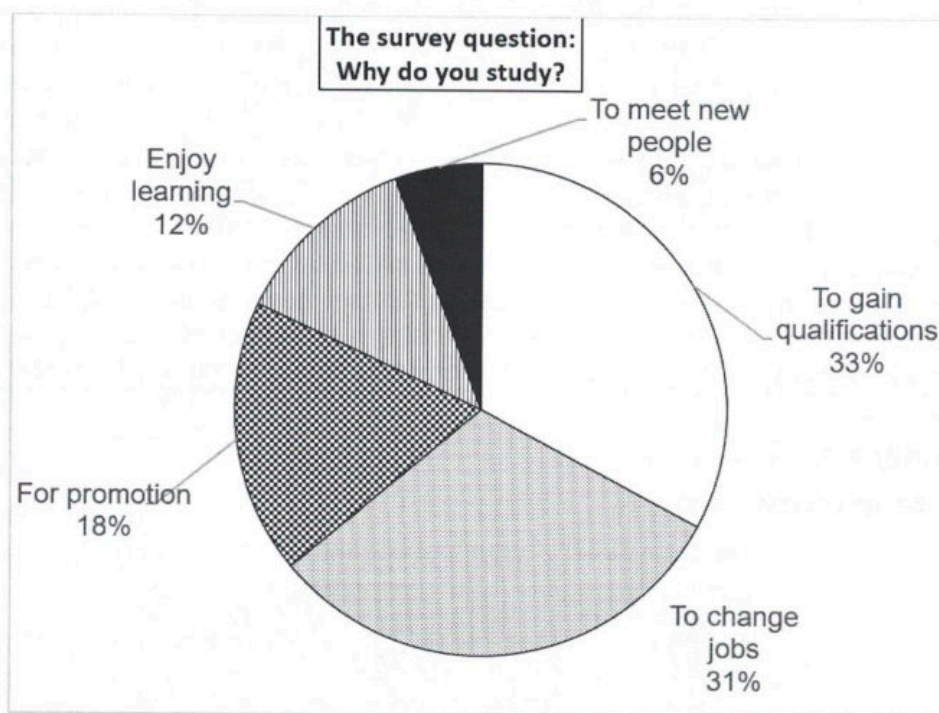
11) Unfortunately, when people develop new skills, they can face certain problems. (The fourth aspect is on all people in general, not on teenagers). 12) One of them is giving up what they learn once they experience difficulties. (This is a mistake in Text Organisation. You cannot refer to all people as 'he'. The appropriate forms are he or she, he/she or they). 13) To tackle the problem, such people should find teachers that motivate and encourage their students no matter how fast their progress is. (This first clause is a clause of reason, you need to use an infinitive or else it sounds like a simultaneous actions). 14) This could help learn from mistakes and help people continue mastering their skills. (You should explain how the previous idea works. Do not make suggestions or give advice).

15) In conclusion, I believe the most important skill to learn for me is critical thinking. ('To sum up' is the wrong linker because you do not summarise everything you have written in the final paragraph). 16) It helps measure possible outcomes and sift through a great deal of information I obtain daily. (According to the task, you should explain your point of view. The first sentence does not sound like an explanation).

Writing Task 38. Task 2 (sample answer on page 175)

Imagine that you are doing a project on **the reasons why adults in Zetland decide to study**. You have found some data on the subject – the results of a survey (see the pie chart below).

Comment on the survey data and give your opinion on the subject of the project.



Write **200-250 words**.

Use the following plan:

- make an opening statement on the subject of the project;
- select and report 2-3 facts;
- make 1-2 comparisons where relevant and give your comments;
- outline a problem that one can face studying and suggest a way of solving it;
- conclude by giving and explaining your opinion on the importance of studying during your life after school.